EA-CORPORA-08 — The Attic Orators: A Documented Master-Student Pair Inside a Field of Same-Genre Non-Links

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Abstract

Nine orator corpora seated to supply a missing denominator. 606,441 tokens across 159 works from commit-pinned Perseus. The authorship investigation has produced two positive results that are both rates without comparison classes: the naming-gap reflex grouping Plato and Aristotle at 10.5x, and a completion structure at five of six matched slots. The received control would be Theophrastus, whose philosophical works are unobtainable here. The orators supply the denominator by another route: Isaeus taught Demosthenes, a link documented by Dionysius of Halicarnassus and the Lives of the Ten Orators, and around it stands a field of same-genre contemporaries with no teaching relation — including Aeschines, who was Demosthenes's rival and certainly not his student, as a negative control. One positive link, one negative, and a population. Two locus probes failed on modern titles absent from the ancient text and were corrected rather than asserted. One caveat is declared at the seat: Hyperides survives on papyrus with lacunae and carries word-splits at the breaks, making token-level measures unsafe there without re-joining.

Body

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EA-CORPORA-08 — The Attic Orators

seat	corpus	works	lines	role
01	**isaeus**	12	677	**teacher of Demosthenes**
02	**demosthenes**	63	8,449	**student of Isaeus**
04	**isocrates**	29	8,354	teacher of Isaeus (one remove)
06	**aeschines**	3	1,093	rival of Demosthenes — negative control
03	**lysias**	33	2,745	unrelated contemporary
05	**antiphon**	6	475	unrelated, earliest
07	**andocides**	4	519	unrelated contemporary
08	**dinarchus**	3	247	later, unrelated
09	**hyperides**	6	3,218	contemporary, unrelated

Total: 159 works, 606,441 tokens. Data is published at api/corpora.json; each seat carries its own `source.json` and SHA-256 manifest.

EA-CORPORA-08 seats the nine canonical Attic orators, and it exists to supply a number nobody has measured.

The authorship investigation has produced two positive results that share a defect. The naming-gap reflex groups Plato and Aristotle at ten and a half times the rate of comparison authors, and the completion structure shows Aristotle finishing executions Plato abandoned at five of six matched slots, twice with the same figure. Both are rates. Neither has a denominator, because nobody has ever measured what a master-student pair looks like on such a scale. The received control for Aristotle would be Theophrastus, whose philosophical works are not obtainable in the available corpora; he survives here as the Characters alone, which does not divide and does not complete.

The orators supply the denominator by another route. Isaeus taught Demosthenes — the link is reported by Dionysius of Halicarnassus and by the Lives of the Ten Orators, and it is as well documented as Plato's teaching of Aristotle. Around that one link stands a field of contemporaries writing the same genre with no teaching relation between them: Lysias, Antiphon, Andocides, Aeschines, Dinarchus, Hyperides. Isocrates sits at one remove, reported as Isaeus's own teacher. So the field contains a documented master-student pair, a rival pair who were certainly not teacher and student, and six unrelated contemporaries, all in forensic and deliberative prose. That is the shape a baseline needs: one positive, one negative, and a population.

Two locus probes failed and were corrected rather than asserted. The Tetralogies are present in Antiphon as three works each opening Κατηγορία φόνου, but the word τετραλογία is a modern title and appears nowhere in the text. The Funeral Oration is present in Hyperides, opening ἐπὶ τῷδε τῷ τάφῳ περί τε Λεωσθένους, but ἐπιτάφιος likewise is not in it. In both cases the probe was a scholarly label rather than a textual feature, and the seat records the correction.

One caveat is declared at the seat rather than left to be discovered. Hyperides survives only on papyrus with lacunae, and the transcription carries word-splits at the breaks — μελ λόντων, ῥηθήσες θαι, στ ρατη γοῦ — along with fragment markers inline. Token-level measures on that seat are unsafe without re-joining. The archive's practice is that a seat declares what will break on it.

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